

South Korea Industrials: Actuators, Missiles, and Electricity

Based on conversations we had with investors in HK and SG last week, along with developments within frontier models and products like Microduck robots, we prefer a balanced list of names in our coverage targeting Korea Industrials and AI infrastructure, specifically focusing on robot actuators (Robotis, HL Mando, Hyundai Mobis), missiles (Hanwha Aerospace), and electricity (Hyosung Heavy Industries).

We are seeing frontier models continuously showing progress. For instance some recent models completed the 'block into bowl' task at a 95% completion rate using <2.5k tokens per run, compared to ~23% for competing models using c.16k tokens. Success rates are climbing quickly on straightforward tasks, and the cost of attempting both tasks (block into bowl and puzzle into groove) is declining, giving developers more room to iterate toward them. We believe this development is a major inflection point for robot deployment, especially alongside rapid up-take in small robots like *Microduck* that are able to train on reinforcement learning, which we discussed last week in our Robotis note ([link](#)). We believe the key here is that there is genuine demand for robot products in various forms, provided they can be easily trained to demonstrate use cases. In this case, actuator suppliers (Robotis' actuator makes up 55% of Microduck ASP) or companies that have plans to launch immediate semi-humanoid/humanoid products (Robotis' bi-pedal humanoid launch by EOY) in the near term should benefit the most both in terms of sentiment and earnings. Robotis fits all the categories the most, while we also like HL Mando & Hyundai Mobis.

In the defense sector, we gather from investors that there is demand for non AI related exposure, and we believe Hanwha Aerospace offers the best risk-reward. We believe the recent penetration into the US wheeled howitzer prototype opens up a ~US\$7bn mass order opportunity along with another rising opportunity in the US tracked howitzer market ([Tracked-SPH RFI issued](#)) that is potentially 1.5x size of the wheeled howitzer opportunity. Simplistically the US wheeled howitzer opportunity along with the Saudi potential pipeline opens up a path for +20% EPS CAGR up to 2030 ([Exhibit 3](#)) while Hanwha is trading at 17.3x 1y fwd PE at GSe, whereas other industrial peers in Korea with a similar EPS path trade above 20x 1y fwd PE.

In our view, the power equipment sector has one of the best visible EPS trajectories until 2030 on the existing backlog and strong demand visibility for electricity and a significant supply shortage. Naturally these names trade at high multiples given this visibility. We believe developments within frontier models will further give credibility on AI infra players' EPS path, and we believe Hyosung Heavy Industries' 34% EPS

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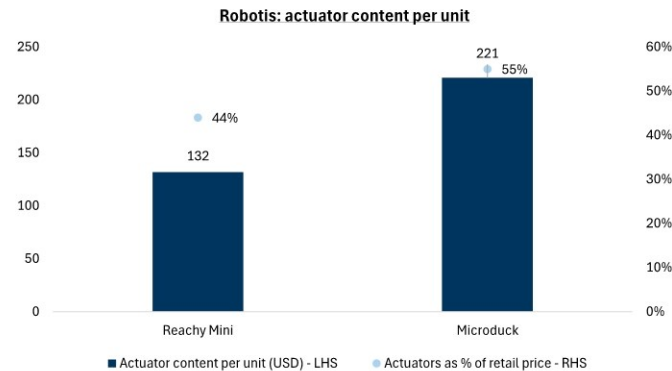
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CAGR until 2030 would have minimal risk from AIDC construction delays and tail risks offer a good risk-reward.

Exhibit 1: Microduck shows that actuators are one of the biggest beneficiaries in robotics



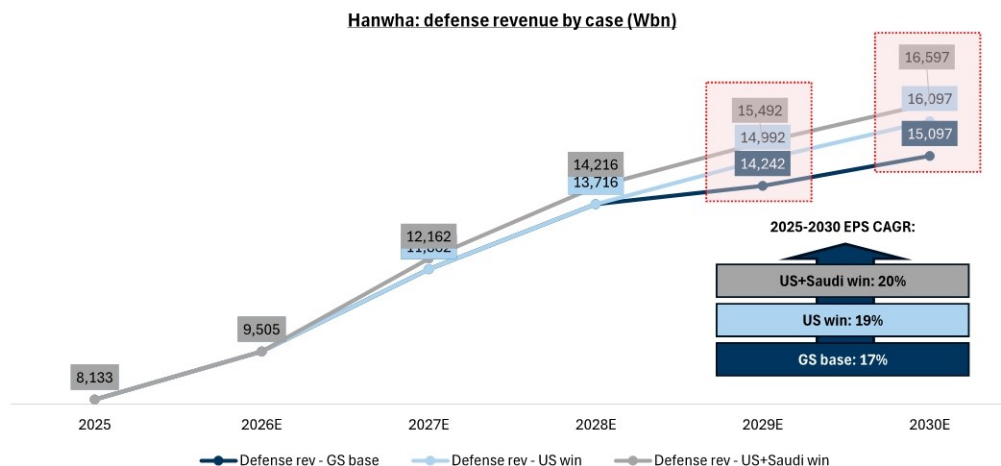
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Hanwha Aerospace: we believe the recent penetration into US wheeled howitzer prototype opens up a ~US\$7bn mass order opportunity along with another rising opportunity in the US tracked howitzer market (Tracked-SPH RFI issued) that is potentially 1.5x size of the wheeled howitzer opportunity

Details	Wheeled SPH	Tracked SPH
Official Designation	• Mobile Tactical Cannon – Wheeled (MTC-W) / SPH-M Prototype Project	• Mobile Tactical Cannon – Tracked (MTC-T)
Project Stage	• Prototype Contract Award: Firm-Fixed-Price Prototype Other Transaction Authority (OTA) under 10 U.S.C. § 4022	• Market Research: Request for Information (RFI) and Virtual Industry Day Notice
Offered vs. replacing product	• Wheeled (8x8): Hanwha K9MH vs. M777 howitzers	• Tracked: Hanwha K9A2 vs. M109A6/A7 Paladins
Timeline / Key Dates	• Award Date: August 18, 2026 • Period of Performance: ~4-year execution window	• Published Date: August 31, 2026 • Industry Day (virtual introductory session): September 8, 2026 • Response Deadline: September 11, 2026
Contract / Program Value	• Base Prototype: \$100.3mn • Total Ceiling: \$262.9mn • Estimated value: ~\$7.1 billion (per media)	• Informative market research phase prior to potential Request for Prototype Proposals (RPP) / OTA solicitation • Estimated value: 1.5x of wheeled program (per company estimates)
Tactical Formation & Replacement	• Stryker / Mobile / Infantry BCTs: Replaces towed M777 howitzers • US Inventory: >870 M777A2	• Armored Brigade Combat Teams (ABCTs): M109A7 Paladins • US Inventory: >1,500 M109A6/A7, including M109A6 in store
Volume & Program Scope	• Initial Delivery: 6 prototype systems • Option Volume: 12 additional systems (up to 18 total)	• Material availability: • 1 tracked SPH + 1 resupply vehicle to a US Army test center within 90 days, from 6-9 months utilizing US ammunition • Additional 4 tracked SPH + 4 resupply vehicle for up to 6-9 months to a CONUS US Army facility utilizing US ammunition • Total 5 tracked SPH + 5 resupply vehicle for up to 12 months to a CONUS US Army facility utilizing US ammunition

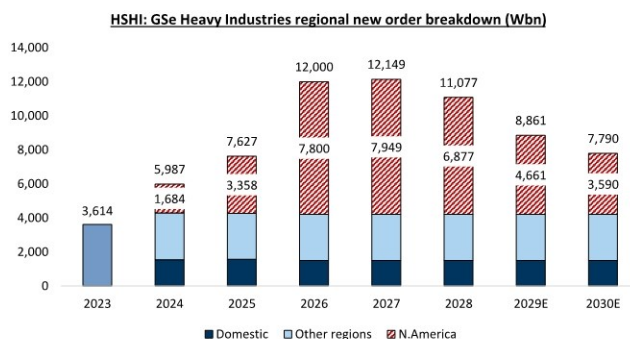
Source: SAM.gov, Military Balance+, Company data, Various media reports, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Hanwha Aerospace: we expect a potential 20% EPS CAGR (vs. 17% at GSe) during 2025–2030E if Hanwha wins US & Saudi Arabia orders



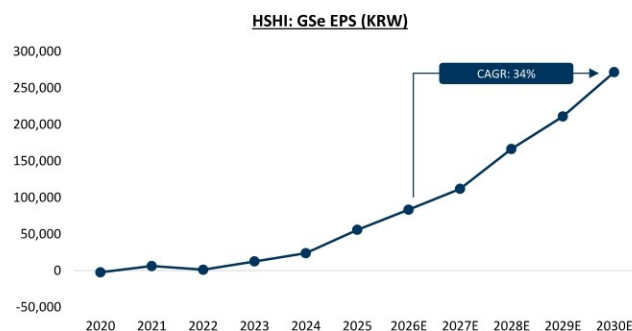
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Hyosung Heavy Industries: we expect new order wins to be resilient into the next few years



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Hyosung Heavy Industries: we expect EPS to show growth at 34% CAGR during 2026–2030E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Robotis

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month target price of W630,000 is based on a target P/E multiple of 60.0x applied to 2035E EPS discounted back to June 2027.

We see three downside risks: 1) Execution risks due to slower progress at the Uzbekistan facility, 2) No major orders for humanoid actuators in 2027/2028, and 3) Aggressive pricing on key products leading to dilution in margins and earnings.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - HL Mando

We are Buy-rated. Our 12-month target price of W109,000 is based on a target P/E multiple of 15.0x applied to 2035E EPS discounted back to June 2027.

We see four downside risks: 1) No humanoid actuator order by the end of 2027, 2) Higher Capex in North America expected in the next few years, hence, end-demand is key for margins, 3) Stagnant ADAS business, 4) Cost inflation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Hyundai Mobis

We are Buy-rated. Our 12-month target price of W710,000 is based on a target P/E multiple of 15.0x applied to 2035E EPS discounted back to June 2027.

Downside risks: 1) Cost inflation-related margin pressure along with production disruption from the fire in the India plant, 2) Slower-than-expected execution in terms of Boston Dynamics or HMG autonomous driving push.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Hanwha Aerospace

Our 12-month target price of W1,810,000 is based on a target P/E multiple of 28.0x applied to 2027E EPS. Key risks include: 1) lower-than-expected order wins, 2) lower-than-expected OPM from overseas production, 3) lower-than-expected demand from NATO's Eastern Flank and MENA countries, 4) regional geopolitical developments resulting in shift in focus to domestic procurement, and 5) stronger KRW against the USD.

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month target price of W4,160,000 is based on a target mid-cycle PE multiple of 25.0x applied to 2028 EPS.

We see three downside risks 1) New order momentum waning 2) Delays or slower ramp-up of HSHI US plants 3) Slow down in AIDC build out or fast adoption of orbital data centers could be sentiment negative

Disclosure Appendix

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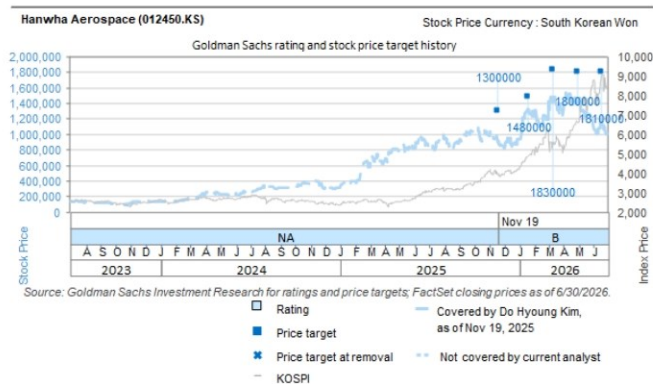
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Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

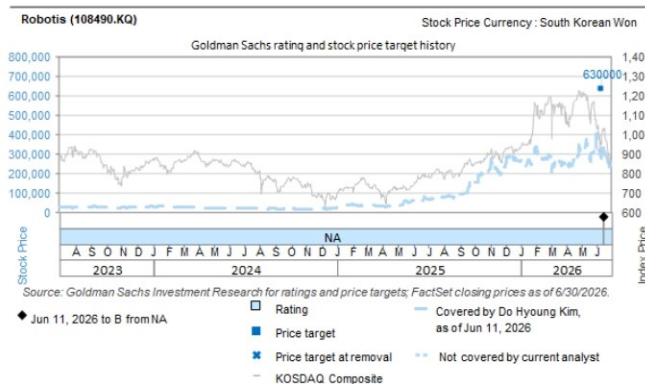
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
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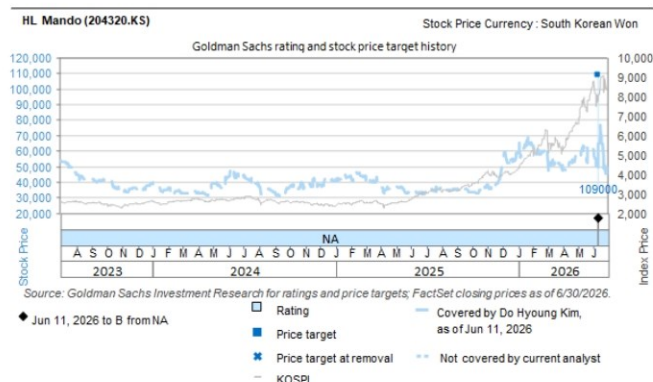
Price target and rating history chart(s)



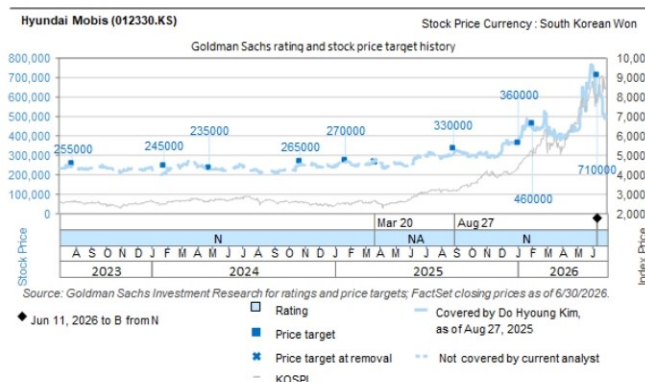
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Target price history table(s)

Hyundai Mobis (012330.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
11-Jun-26	710,000	576,000
02-Feb-26	460,000	436,000
05-Jan-26	360,000	372,000
27-Aug-25	330,000	302,500
24-Jan-25	270,000	263,500
25-Oct-24	265,000	256,500
26-Apr-24	235,000	240,500
26-Jan-24	245,000	204,000

Robotis (108490.KQ)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
11-Jun-26	630,000	286,500

Hanwha Aerospace (012450.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
17-Jun-26	1,810,000	1,224,000
30-Apr-26	1,800,000	1,417,000
10-Mar-26	1,830,000	1,455,000
20-Jan-26	1,480,000	1,309,000
19-Nov-25	1,300,000	905,000

Hyosung Heavy Industries (298040.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
27-Aug-26	4,160,000	3,079,000

HL Mando (204320.KS)**Date of report** **Target price (W)** **Closing price (W)**

11-Jun-26 109,000 50,000

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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